

Lore:Magic Script

< Lore: Linguistics

The UESPWiki – Your source for The Elder Scrolls, in memory of Julian LeFay

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This alphabet is seen in the Master Illusion Texts in the College of Winterhold, on Shalidor's Insights and the Oghma Infinium. It has connections to the Mages Guild, and some of the symbols in it resemble others used by the guild. There are only five known texts using this alphabet, and as of yet there is no known translation for any of them. However, as the symbols are given in font-form, rather than images, we can see which letter each character represents by using the Creation Kit. The name "Magic Script" is only seen in the Creation Kit, as no name for the alphabet is given within the games.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
													
O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	1	2
													

* The letter X and the numbers are not seen in any of the books, but they can be seen by editing the books in the Creation Kit. There are no symbols for the other digits.

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Uses

The books that use this alphabet are below:

- Master Illusion Text (1)
- Master Illusion Text (2)
- Master Illusion Text (3)
- Master Illusion Text (4)
- Shalidor's Insights
- Oghma Infinium

Some of the symbols also resemble others used by the Mages guild.

- The letter 'K' () resembles the symbol used to represent the school of Destruction, as seen on skill books and spell tomes.
- The letter 'E' () resembles the symbol for the Mysticism skill seen in Oblivion.



A Magic Script letter 'K' on a Destruction spell tome

Shalidor's Insights

The book Shalidor's Insights actually has some translatable words using the Magic Script. The block reads:

ALDUIN A
VA RI A O
NODICA DE
AKATOSH E
S SUPERFI
C I A L



A page from Shalidor's Insights

M E N T E
P A R E C E S E
C O M O S E U
C O L E G A N O S

The passage is actually Portuguese: "Alduin é a variação Nórdica de Akatosh e só superficialmente parece-se com o seu colega nos", meaning "Alduin is the Nordic variation of Akatosh, and superficially resembles his counterpart in the [Nine Divines]", the same as the first somewhat-legible English paragraph on the same page and a sentence from *Varieties of faith in the Empire*.

On another page (which features are stylized golden spiral, as seen here: Arcane Scribblings p.3 (<http://host.conseiljedi.com/~wolf/Skyrim/arcane%20scribblings/arcae04.png>)), the columns down the left- and right-hand sides contain some translatable words. First, the left-hand side can be transcribed top to bottom as:

QAACONDUZIUOAQUI AESTEP

This string of letters contains the word **conduziu**, which is Portuguese for *(it has) led* (the 3rd person singular perfect past tense of **conduzir** to lead), **o aqui** (to) here and **a este** to this. Putting this together: ...led to here, to this...". The right-hand column is transcribed thus:

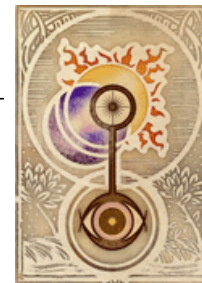
QESKYRIMSEPTIMUSVIVEEMU

In this string, we find *Skyrim* and *Septimus* (presumably referencing Septimus Signus) and then **vive em** which is again Portuguese, for *live(s) in*.... Potentially, this could be rendered as: *Septimus lives in Skyrim* (ignoring the three seemingly obsolete letters QE and U and also ignoring normal Portuguese word order, which is normally subject-verb-object).

The letters around the spiral are (from the outside in): STUVW. This seems to be meaningless, simply being in consecutive alphabetical order. The text beneath is illegible and in a different script.

Another page featuring a symbol similar to that of destruction magic (as seen here (<http://i39.tinypic.com/szvl9u.png>)) also contains a passage using Magic Script. It is a transliteration of English:

ALDUIN S CIVILI
ZATION WAS THE
DRAGON CULT OF
ATMORA HE S BA
SICALLY THE
DRAGON GOD ON
EARTH THE
DRAGON HIGH
PRIESTS ARE HIS
ACOLYTES AND
EVERYTHING IS
ORDERED



The Mysticism skill icon, which bears a striking resemblance to the Magic Script letter 'E'

Rendered in plain text as: *Alduin's civilization was the Dragon Cult of Atmora. He's basically the Dragon God on Earth. The Dragon High Priests are his acolytes and everything is ordered.* The large glyph in the top left is an "H".

Gallery



Notes

- Certain Dunmer have their skin covered in magic script seen as white tattoos, which are wards against the undead.^[UOL 1]

References

Note: The following references are considered to be unofficial sources. They are included to round off this article and may not be authoritative or conclusive.

1. Ted Peterson's posts in *Playing Houses*

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